Kabui Charles

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Profile

Ten years building software. I now run Oark full-time: we build iTax Help and Blober.io, publish ToKnow.ai, and help other teams build, ship and run software, including SEO and AI deployment. Before that, I spent five years at Microsoft building AI-powered, agentic experiences in M365 Copilot. Earlier I founded Oark Library and grew it to 130,000 users and 400,000 materials before archiving it in 2024. I hold an MSc in Data Science from Strathmore.

Work Experience

Founder, Oark *Jul 2026 - Present*

- Run Oark's software consulting: helping teams build, ship and run software, from architecture and cloud cost reviews to SEO and AI deployment
- Building Blober.io, Built iTax Help and writing at ToKnow.ai
- Previously built Oark Library to 130,000 users; archived in 2024

Technologies: *TypeScript, React, Python, Node.js, Azure, AWS*

Full-stack Software Engineer, Microsoft *Apr 2021 - Jul 2026*

- Built AI-powered, agentic experiences in M365 Copilot: Researcher, Copilot Chat, and the shared infrastructure underneath
- Developed and maintained enterprise components and services used across multiple teams

Technologies: *ASP.NET, C#, TypeScript, React, Azure, KustoQL*

Android Software Engineer, Hava Cab *Oct 2020 - Apr 2021*

- Improved accuracy and reliability of the driver app under real-world constraints
- Refined core trip logic, which cut cost estimation errors
- Supported backend and frontend integration across mobile and web

Technologies: *Android, Java, Kotlin, JavaScript, ReactJS*

Full-stack Software Engineer, Maramoja Transport *May 2018 - Nov 2020*

- Architected a corporate trip audit tool (marker-checker) used by enterprise clients
- Maintained the Node.js services behind the taxi platform
- Maintained the React web app and Android apps for clients and drivers

Technologies: *JavaScript, ReactJS, NodeJS, Android, Java, MySQL*

Full-stack Software Engineer, Pageone *Mar 2016 - Apr 2018*

- Led development of Daktari.net, a healthcare portal that connected patients and doctors across Kenya
- Pushed early into serverless on Azure Functions and WebJobs before it was the obvious choice
- Integrated MPESA, Stripe, and PayPal into a production platform; payment APIs fail in ways their documentation does not cover

Technologies: *ASP.NET MVC, C#, JavaScript, KnockoutJS, Azure*

Freelance Software Engineer *Jan 2015 - May 2016*

- Built bespoke tooling for SMEs: insurance report systems and web portals
- Delivered WordPress sites and custom themes

Technologies: *C#, WPF, Windows Forms, JavaScript, WordPress, PHP*

Projects & Initiatives

iTax Help *2026 - Present*

Kenyan tax, made simple, for everyone in Kenya from a first payslip to a company's monthly return. A web app that prepares KRA's monthly P10 PAYE return in the browser, without KRA's macro-enabled Excel workbook, and builds an upload file that matches one KRA accepted, byte for byte. It also has PAYE, NSSF, SHA/SHIF and housing levy calculators, KRA's fringe benefit tax rates and publications, and a check that an accountant (ICPAK) or advocate (LSK) is registered. Built with TypeScript, React and Hono on Cloudflare Workers. Visit Site

Blober.io *Dec 2025 - Present*

The safest, easiest way to move cloud files. A local-first workflow engine for cloud storage transfers with metadata-aware path organisation. Users wire up source and destination providers (S3, Azure Blob, Google Drive, Dropbox), define how files should be reorganised on arrival, and run the transfer locally. Credentials never leave their machine. Visit Site

ToKnow.ai *May 2024 - Present*

Information to knowledge: research and writing on AI, security, finance, and technology, with about 390 posts so far. Visit Site

@mckabue/react-validate *2025 - Present*

A type-safe React form validation hook with zero dependencies. View on npm

@mckabue/react-use-async *2026 - Present*

A React hook for managing async operations with loading states, error handling, and data merging. View on npm

@mckabue/no-same-type-params *2026 - Present*

An ESLint rule that disallows consecutive function parameters sharing the same type annotation. View on npm

Oark Library (Founder) *2017 - 2024*

A digital library for academic and educational resources, built from scratch. It grew to 130,000 users, 400,000 resources, and a peak of 1,500 new signups a day, with almost no marketing budget. Archived Site

- Engineered the platform end-to-end: web, mobile, and backend
- Hired and led the engineering team
- Kept the platform and user data secure through repeated attacks

Education

- MSc Data Science and Analytics, Strathmore University
- BSc Software Engineering, Kisii University

Technical Proficiencies

- Languages: *JavaScript, C#, Python, Kotlin, Java*
- Frontend: *HTML5, CSS3, SASS, ReactJS, VueJS*
- Backend: *ASP.NET MVC, NodeJS, Flask*
- Databases: *MSSQL, MySQL, ElasticSearch, MongoDB, KustoQL, Azure Table*
- Cloud: *Azure, AWS*
- Mobile: *Native Android Development*
- Architectures: *Monolithic, Serverless, GraphQL, RestAPI*